# THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

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Patron:
Her Majesty The Queen
Hon. President:
H.B.M. Ambassador

Incorporated by Royal Charter

## NEWSLETTER - JANUARY 2011

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### Chairman's Report

Firstly I wish you and yours a very Happy and Peaceful New Year.

The Paris Branch looks forward to a busy year, not least in celebrating its 90th Anniversary, since we were formed in May 1921, a month before the formation of the British Legion in the UK. Your Committee is currently preparing to hold an Anniversary Dinner Dance in May.

May I on your behalf thank the outgoing Committee on their work in the last Legion Year. By definition our work is voluntary and the Paris Branch has relied heavily on our hard-working Secretary, Janet Warby, and Treasurer, David Blanchard, to keep the show on the road. As you know David Blanchard stood down at the AGM after 20 years in post. At the time of writing we have not yet found a successor, so David is prepared to act as Acting Treasurer until we find the right candidate. If you have friends who would rise to this challenge I should be very pleased to hear from you.

Next, on your behalf, I wish to thank our Poppy Organizer Joyce Gilhooley. Final figures are still being computed, but she believes her result in the 2010 Appeal is close to last year's record total. To achieve this during an economic downturn speaks for itself, and we congratulate her warmly.

Because of the inclement weather on the date of our Christmas Tombola we were obliged to postpone the draw to January 20th. The prize-winners are listed below on Pages 3-4. We thank warmly all those who participated.

Alongside our Welfare and Social activities we are constantly reminded of our Remembrance duties. We plan a visit to the battlefields of the Somme once more in the Spring. As usual our guide will be Branch member Colonel Oliver Warman, late Welsh Guards. We will release details shortly so that you can put the dates in your diary.

A little nearer home it is high time that we held a ceremony on one of the sites of Commonwealth war graves in the Paris area;. High on that list is Les Gonards in Versailles. Again details will be released in good time.

**We will remember them**

## SOCIAL NEWS FROM THE SECRETARIES

Dear Members,

Happy New Year to you all . This year marks the 90th Anniversary of The Royal British Legion. We would like to ask you all to note the 19th May as a truly special date in your diaries. You are invited together with your family and friends to join us at the Ecole Militaire for a Dinner Dance to celebrate this milestone in our history. Further information about this event will follow in our next Newsletter.

The Paris Branch is, in fact, the oldest branch in The Royal British Legion, we were formed on 13th May, 1921, about six weeks before the Legion was formally announced in the United Kingdom.

Mark Yates would like to remind any members who have not paid their subs, that now is the time to do so. We have to send back any unclaimed cards to London by the end of this month otherwise the Branch will be charged for these cards, which as we have said many times before, is a cost we cannot handle.

Our Social Secretary, Joan Hicks, has come up with dates for the monthly lunches at rue des Acacias.. You will find these in this Newsletter. We hope to see as many of you at these lunches as possible. This is one way of catching up with friends and in a way is our very own 'Social Centre'.

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|---|---|---|
| Janet Warby | Joan Hicks | Mark Yates |
| Hon. Secretary | Social Secretary | Membership Secretary |

## TOMBOLA PRIZE LIST RESULTS

| Name | Ticket Number | Prize | Number on Prize | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hicks J. | 3288 | Mickey Mouse Toy | 1 | ® |
| Mitchell R. | 0398 | Steak Knives & Board | 2 | |
| Peron M. | 1068 | Large Pencil & Sharpener | 3 | |
| Tucker J. | 2844 | Man's Scarf | 4 | |
| O'Reilly D. | 0347 | Fancy Bag | 5 | |
| Davey K. | 3383 | Picnic Set | 6 | ® |
| Longley O.G. | 2991 | Memo Pad | 7 | ® |
| Corrigan G. | 3043 | Bag & Kitchen Tidy | 8 | |
| Bennett T. | 1273 | Oven Mitt | 9 | ® |
| Warby R. | 0128 | Christmas Book | 10 | ® |
| Saint-Gilles Leo | 1229 | Photo Frame | 11 | |
| Wells D. | 0002 | DVD & Autograph Book | 12 | |
| Leck F. | 3787 | Tea Infuser | 13 | |
| Spencer-Bernard C. | 2156 | DVD 3 box set | 14 | ® |
| Hastings Pamela | 0735 | Anne Perry Book | 15 | |
| Riols C. | 0273 | Surprise parcel | 16 | ® |
| de Saint-Jean M. | 3415 | Book – Catlore | 17 | |
| Stam A. | 2589 | Ladies Wallet | 18 | |
| Peron (daughter-in-law) | 1065 | 2 Children's books | 19 | |
| Warby G. | 0124 | Bombay Gin | 20 | ® |
| Warby D. | 0130 | Candle & Silver Spoon | 21 | ® |
| Baxter S. | 1225 | Box & Eau de Toilette | 22 | ® |
| Riols O. | 0267 | Ferrero Chocolates | 23 | ® |
| Bateau-Clubb R. | 1213 | 2 jars of fruit jam | 24 | |
| Gillespie R. | 0828 | Waistcoat from Disneyland | 25 | |
| Clack L. | 2188 | 2 Tickets for Bateaux Mouche | 26 | |
| Peridi H. | 1050 | Disney Toy & Box | 27 | |
| Corrigan F. | 3050 | Pencil & Autograph Book | 28 | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Leck N. | 3794 | Anne Perry Book | 29 | |
| Yates M. | 3721 | Table Cloth | 30 | ® |
| Bennett D. | 1275 | Rain Mac | 31 | ® |
| Renouard J-P | 0291 | Calculator | 32 | |
| Warby H. | 0123 | Bottle of Champagne | 33 | ® |
| Thourot C. | 2828 | DFDS Channel Crossing Trip | 34 | |
| Riols Y. | 0269 | Tapestry Picture | 35 | ® |
| Davey M. | 3389 | Mince Pies | 36 | ® |
| Leck D. | 3789 | Mince Pies | 37 | |
| Camus | 1389 | Fruity Xmas pud & Doc. Case | 38 | |
| Warby J. | 0129 | P&O Ferries Trip Calais/Dover | 39 | ® |
| Hicks J. | 3283 | Bottle of Whisky | 40 | ® |

We would like to thank all those who took part in our draw and gave prizes, we would also like to thank, Disneyland Paris, P&O Ferries, DFDS Shipping and Bateaux Mouche for their support.

® = Prize received. Would all prize winners please contact Joan Hicks – 01 30 54 33 06 – to arrange to collect their prize before 31st March 2011.

**CLUB LUNCHES**

| | |
|---|---|
| February<br>Wednesday 9th | 3 course lunch which includes Kir & Coffee. Wine or other drinks to be obtained from the bar & paid for separately. Price €15 per person<br>12h15 for 12h30 |
| March<br>Thursday 10th | 3 course lunch which includes Kir & Coffee. Wine or other drinks to be obtained from the bar & paid for separately. Price €15 per person<br>12h15 for 12h30 |
| April<br>Wednesday 6th | 3 course lunch which includes Kir & Coffee. Wine or other drinks to be obtained from the bar & paid for separately. Price €15 per person<br>12h15 for 12h30 |
| May<br>Wednesday 11th | 3 course lunch which includes Kir & Coffee. Wine or other drinks to be obtained from the bar & paid for separately. Price €15 per person<br>12h15 for 12h30 |
| June<br>Wednesday 8th | 3 course lunch which includes Kir & Coffee. Wine or other drinks to be obtained from the bar & paid for separately. Price €15 per person<br>12h15 for 12h30 |

To reserve your place at any of these lunches please contact Joan Hicks on 01 30 54 33 06 or fill out the coupon and send it to Joan Hicks at 6 rue des Petits Prés, 78810 Feucherolles. Please enclose your cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion. If you have to cancel, please let Joan know 2 days before the date for a refund. Any cancellations after this date will not be entitled to a refund.

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Reservation Slip for RBL Lunches

I ---------- would like to reserve ---------- places at the lunch to be held on

9th February* 10th March* 6th April* 11th May* 8th June*

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion for €----------

Signed---------- Dated ----------

*Please tick the dates you would like to attend the lunch(es)

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